

Week 2 Lecture

Topic:

Part 1: Listening and oral expression

6 SPEAKING

People should need a driving licence to ride an electric scooter.

- a  **3.12** Listen to two people talking. Do they agree or disagree with the statement?
- b  **3.13** Listen to some extracts from a. Complete the gaps in the information box.



Giving your opinion

- 1 _____, I don't think people _____
_____ a driving licence...
- 2 In _____, e-scooters are...
- 3 But I think people _____
to ride them...

We often use *should(n't)* + verb to say what we think is the right thing or a good thing (to do).

- c Look at the statements below. Tick (✓) the ones you agree with and cross (X) the ones you disagree with. Think about your reasons.
- ☐ People who drink and drive should lose their driving licence for life, even if they did not cause an accident.
 - ☐ Slow drivers cause more accidents than fast drivers.
 - ☐ Speed cameras do not stop accidents, they just make money for the government.
 - ☐ Drivers who are over 80 are as dangerous as young drivers.
 - ☐ Cyclists in cities should only be allowed in cycle lanes, not where cars and other vehicles drive.
 - ☐ It should be illegal to eat or drink when you're driving.
 - ☐ The minimum age for riding a motorbike should be 25.
 - ☐ The speed limit on motorways should be lower.
- d In groups, take turns to give your opinions on a statement in c. Do the others in the group agree or disagree with you? Use the language from the information box.

Part 2: Reading comprehension

1 READING

a Look carefully at the book illustration. What is happening? What stereotype is it challenging? Why do you think stereotypes are harmful?

b Read an article from an American sociology website and check your ideas in a. What's the difference between a stereotype and a generalization?

c Read the article again and match 1–4 to A–D.

- 1 Generalizing is useful because it helps us to...
- 2 Stereotyping is a problem because it is based on...
- 3 It's wrong to make assumptions about people based on things like...
- 4 Generalizing is neutral, but...

- A ☐ stereotyping is negative.
B ☐ ideas that are not true.
C ☐ understand the world around us.
D ☐ appearance, ethnicity, or gender.

d Do you think people are more aware now than in the past of the harmful effects of stereotyping? Think of an example.

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Generalize, but don't stereotype!

We use **generalizations** to help us to understand things and people. Generalizations are based on facts and evidence. For example, if we see a flat surface with four legs, we generalize that it's a table because most objects like this are tables. If we see someone who looks over 80 years old, we generalize that they are retired because most people at this age don't work any more.

Unfortunately, sometimes generalizations can become **stereotypes**. A stereotype is a harmful and often negative generalization. We typically stereotype people or things that we do not understand or that we know nothing about. Stereotyping is something to avoid, because it can come from ideas about these groups, not truths. For example:

- It's not appropriate to stereotype based on what people look like. For example, you may assume from their appearance that someone is male, female, white, Afro-Caribbean, Asian, or Latin American. You may be right, but you may also be wrong.
- It's not appropriate to stereotype based on what you think you know about how particular groups of people behave. For example, an outdated gender stereotype is that strong, handsome men save weak, pretty women from danger. Others are that men don't do housework and women can't read maps. However, these abilities are not related to a person's gender; they are individual abilities related to individual people.

Generalizing helps us to navigate our lives, but stereotyping should be avoided because it can easily result in prejudice and discrimination, and can mean that some people cannot achieve their full potential in society.



Part 3: Grammar – Articles

- a** Quotes often express generalizations. Complete these quotes about education with *a* / *an*, *the*, or – (no article).

¹ _____ child educated
only at ² _____ school
is ³ _____ uneducated
child.

George Santayana,
Spanish philosopher

Until we get
¹¹ _____ equality
in ¹² _____
education we will
not be ¹³ _____
equal society.

Sonia Sotomayor,
American lawyer



⁴ _____
greatest university of
all is ⁵ _____
collection of
⁶ _____ books.

Thomas Carlyle,
Scottish philosopher

⁷ _____ extremists
have shown what frightens
them ⁸ _____ most:
⁹ _____ girl with
¹⁰ _____ book.

Malala Yousafzai,
Pakistani educator

*Having one child makes
you ¹⁴ _____ parent.
Having two, you are
¹⁵ _____ referee.*

David Frost,
British journalist



- b** Which ones do you agree with? Which quote(s) do you like best?

articles: *a / an, the*, no article

a / an

- 1 It's **a nice house**.
She's **a lawyer**.  3.14
- 2 I saw **an old man** with **a dog**.
- 3 What **an awful day**!
- 4 I have classes three times **a week**.

- We use *a / an* with singular countable nouns:

- 1 when we say what something is or what somebody does.
- 2 the first time we mention a thing / person.
- 3 in exclamations with *What...!*
- 4 in expressions of frequency.

the

- 1 I saw an old man with a dog. **The dog** was barking.  3.15
- 2 **The bell** rang and my father opened **the door**.
The children are at school.
- 3 **The moon** goes round **the Earth**.
- 4 I'm going to **the cinema** tonight.
- 5 It's **the best** restaurant in town.

- We use *the*:

- 1 when we talk about something we've already mentioned.
- 2 when it's clear what we're referring to.
- 3 when there's only one of something.
- 4 with places in a town, e.g. *cinema, theatre*.
- 5 with superlatives.

no article

- 1 Is it true that **girls** often learn to read earlier than **boys**?  3.16
Love is more important than **money**.
- 2 She's not **at home** today.
I get back **from work** at 5.30.
- 3 I never have **breakfast**.
I'm going to the theatre **on Tuesday**.
- 4 See you **next week**.

- We don't use an article:

- 1 when we are speaking in general (with plural and uncountable nouns), e.g. *I love flowers*.
Compare: *I love **the flowers** in my garden*. (= the specific flowers in that place)
- 2 with some nouns, e.g. *home, work, school, church*, after *at / to / from*.
- 3 before meals, days, and months.
- 4 before *next / last* + day, week, etc.

Activity 1:

Circle the correct form.

I love weddings / *the weddings*!

- 1 Ariana is *nurse* / *a nurse* in a hospital.
A hospital / *The hospital* is a long way from her house.
- 2 What *a horrible day* / *horrible day*! We'll have to eat our picnic in *the car* / *a car*.
- 3 My wife and I like *love stories* / *the love stories*, but our children prefer *the war films* / *war films*.
- 4 We go to *theatre* / *the theatre* about *once a month* / *once the month*.
- 5 I'm having *dinner* / *the dinner* with some friends *the next Friday* / *next Friday*.
- 6 My boyfriend is *chef* / *a chef*. I think he's *the best cook* / *best cook* in the world.
- 7 I'm not sure if I closed *the windows* / *windows* before I left *the home* / *home* this morning.
- 8 In general, I like *dogs* / *the dogs*, but I don't like *dogs* / *the dogs* that live next door to me.
- 9 I got to *the school* / *school* late every day *the last week* / *last week*.
- 10 I think *happiness* / *the happiness* is more important than *money* / *the money*.

Activity 2:

Complete with *a / an, the, or –* (no article).

- A What does the guidebook say about Pizzeria Marco?
B It says that it's a great restaurant.
- 1 A How often do you go to ___ gym?
B About three times ___ week. But I never go on ___ Fridays.
- 2 A What time does ___ train leave?
B In 40 minutes. Can you drop me off at ___ station on your way to ___ work?
- 3 A What ___ amazing dress!
B Thanks. I bought it in ___ sales ___ last month.
- 4 A What's ___ most interesting place to visit in your town?
B Probably ___ castle. It's ___ oldest building.
- 5 A What shall we do ___ next weekend?
B Let's invite Toni for ___ lunch. We could eat in ___ garden.
- 6 A Do you like ___ cats?
B Not really. I prefer ___ dogs. I think they're ___ best pets.
- 7 A Is your mum ___ housewife?
B No, she's ___ teacher. She's always tired when she finishes ___ work.
- 8 A Have you ever had ___ problem in your relationship?
B Yes, but we solved ___ problem and we got married.
- 9 A When is ___ meeting?
B They've changed ___ date. It's on ___ Tuesday now.

Part 4: Listening and oral expression

Only children are more self-confident than children with brothers and sisters.

- a  **3.18** Listen to three people talking. Do they agree or disagree with the statement?
- b  **3.19** Listen to some extracts from a. Complete the gaps in the information box.



Generalizing

- 1 Generally _____, I think it's true that...
- 2 In _____, they behave in a more grown-up way.
- 3 _____ the whole, I think that only children are more independent...
- 4 They _____ to spend a lot of time by themselves.
- 5 They aren't _____ very good at...

- c Work in groups of three. Take turns to talk about the statements. Use the language from the information box.

Children shouldn't be allowed to use **the internet** by themselves until they are 12 years old.

Going **to the cinema** is much better than watching films on TV.

Working **from home** is more enjoyable than going **to work**.

Breakfast is **the most important** meal of the day.

It's important to exercise at least **three times a week**.

Being **a teacher** is **the most stressful job** in **the world**.

Cats make better pets than **dogs** especially for **older people**.

Art and **music** are subjects that are not worth studying **at university**.